



RIP Andy Grove

Andy Grove, former Intel CEO who decided Intel should make processors, not RAM dies at the age of 79. <http://dgit.in/RIPAndyG>



Apple goes social

Criticised earlier for not including environmental strategies, Apple's new missions prove it to be a social enterprise. <http://dgit.in/SocialApple>

IF IT WERE SO EASY WHY ISN'T THE DIGIT CHANNEL FAMOUS?

Good catch sir. Congratulations on your critical reasoning skills. Look, first of all, we're not saying it's easy. There are a number of reasons why the Digit YouTube channel hasn't been able to make it big. What went wrong? This article has made us put on our thinking caps too and after having spoken to so many of these YouTubers we've nailed down a few points we think we need to work on:

1. We're a magazine and website team first and a video team later. We are text content creators in the day and make YouTube videos on the side. Our day-to-day job (rozi roti as some would call it) is to populate the website and magazine. If from tomorrow, we dropped everything else that we do and just concentrated on making YouTube videos, we're pretty sure even our inherent camera shyness wouldn't stand in our way.
2. From the above point you'd wonder whether all of these YouTubers dropped everything (their day jobs, for example) and just started making YouTube videos one fine day. Of course not! They experimented in the initial days of YouTube by putting out videos that didn't adhere to "production quality" norms of today. But pretty soon when they realised that they're on to something, they jumped in with both feet. Keeping up with competition takes effort. If you look at our channel we were creating mobile phone reviews as early as 2010. That's 6 years ago! Were we too early? Not really. We just didn't commit.
3. Every YouTuber starts with average production quality and once you have your subscriber base in place, you need to up your game. Even though you'd have quality content up there, if your videos have just average audio and video quality, bounce-rates start skyrocketing. You end up losing audience at the crucial phase in the entire career timeline.

In the Mumbai office, none of us here are formally trained in filmmaking and thus to make sure we put out quality looking videos on YouTube, we are taking regular lessons by digging up the internet and watching videos on YouTube. Our team members have also been attending the workshop sessions at the YouTube Spaces in Mumbai to master this skill!

The above points are an honest analysis of our own predicament. If you are considering YouTube seriously you should make this 3-point analysis primer for yourself too.

here along with all the information you wish to share. Make full use of the tags section by using all the tags and keywords that relate to your video as it helps your video be search friendly. Ensure all your videos have an intro, not too long, and an outro when the video gets over. Merchandising, giveaways and contests always attract more attention. It's also a healthy practice to reply to comments your viewers leave for you. You can use the creator studio tool to monitor and reply to comments across all videos.

When your channel grows, you will realize that there are three approaches to making videos. The framework is called Hero, Hub, Hygiene, and YouTube recommends channels to follow this strategy framework to grow organic viewership as well as subscribers. Hero videos are videos that reach the masses on a large scale or go viral. Hygiene videos are videos that are made on the core interests relevant to viewer's intentions and interest whereas

Hub videos are regularly scheduled content to ensure your audience keeps coming back to your channel. Hygiene and Hub videos are videos that you will be creating most of the times to keep your subscribers engaged. The entire phenomena ensure you keep on uploading videos constantly along with consistency and variety.

"I follow the Hero, Hub, Hygiene strategy very seriously. My Hero content is all my original stuff, my covers and mashups are my Hub content and my vlogs and other videos constitute towards the Hygiene content. It helps to drive your viewers from popular song covers to your original compositions. That's how I create my fan base and that's how your chances of getting noticed increases and you get to perform at events", says Hanu Dixit.

Measure your success

YouTube analytics plays a very important role to display the engagement and impressions your videos receive. Ana-

lytics help you to measure the pulse of your channel. You also come to know the different trends and behavioural patterns of your viewers. It helps you to understand which videos are popular with your audience along with the breakdown of views, time watched and other numbers for you to crunch on. The demographics section is one of the key tabs that provides a clearer picture of your YouTube audience and keeps you updated with your target audience.

To make full use of YouTube Analytics, you need to first find out how your audience is finding your video. Find out what captivates viewers. Is it your hero content or your hub and hygiene videos from the channel? You also need to look into the watch sessions to understand how engaging your videos have been. Here, the audience retention tab will tell you the average time a viewer spent watching your videos and the peaks and lows.

If your retention rates are very low, you need to work on keeping your audience engaged and prevent them from skipping parts of videos. A retention rate of 50%-60% should be your aim on an average. Remember, this can also go over 100% in case the viewer replays or rewinds parts of the video. Look for unexpected upward spikes and downward dips. During the formation of your future strategies, you can use the data filter provided along with YouTube Analytics to compare between videos that are getting you the clicks.

Subscribers have the potential to consume more videos than non-subscribers in your channel and your aim should be to turn your viewers into subscribers and fans. YouTube Analytics, again plays a very important role here. Along with the demographic and geographical reports, you also need to understand where are your subscribers coming from to be able to promote it on the right platform. The Subscribers report under the engagement section helps you understand this.

Multi-channel networks

Multi-channel networks (MCN) are network entities affiliated with multiple YouTube channels which offer to provide creators with assistance. Programming, getting funds, arranging for neces-